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My role

In Group 7 I was mainly in charge of the animations and of making the peer review video. I took the animation role because [reason, e.g. I wanted to learn how animation works in Unity / I was more confident with it than coding]. My first task was creating a Lego figure in Mechabricks, which was then added to the overall project model. I made a Pirate Skeleton that stands on the mast of the ship and waves with both arms.

The peer review video

We reviewed Group 3, whose project was an interactive server system. To decide what to say, I played through their project a few times and made notes on what stood out. Then I wrote a transcript so I knew exactly what I wanted to say before recording.

Their project was very well researched, and it made their idea feel complete and interesting. The things I thought they did well were:

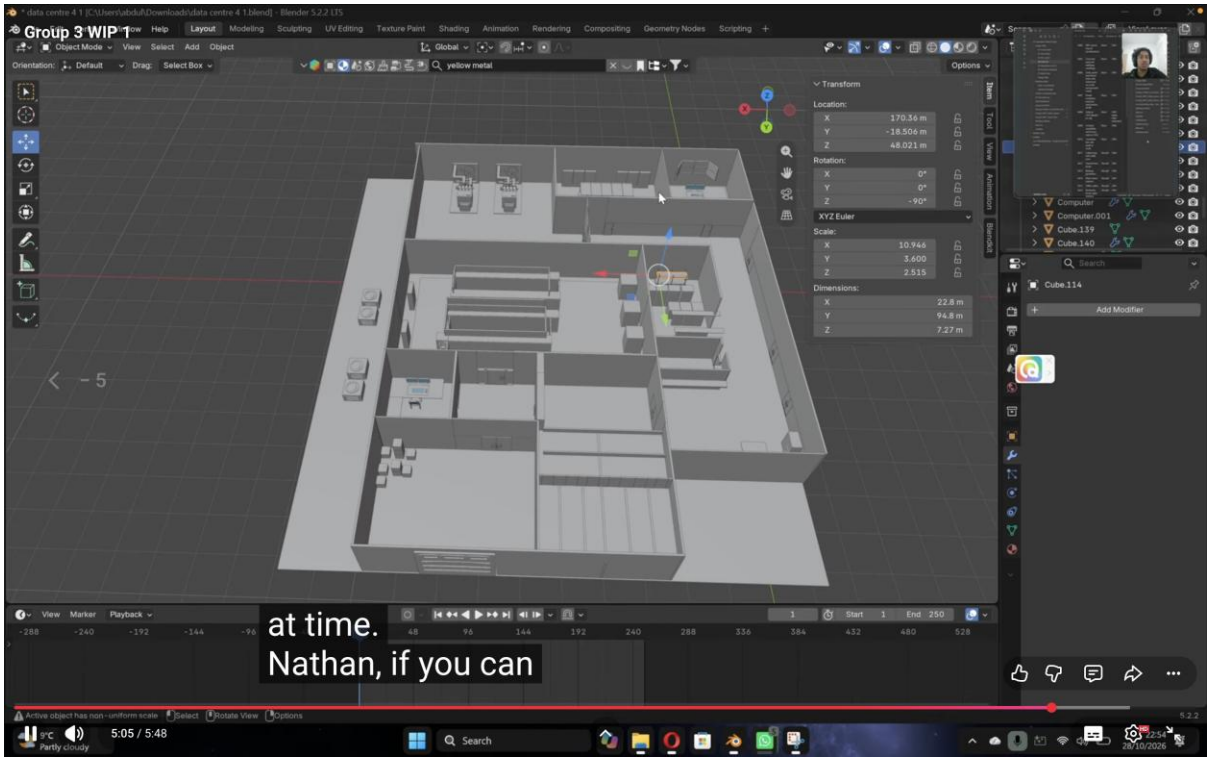
- The research behind their theme
- The look of the scene, the models, the lighting

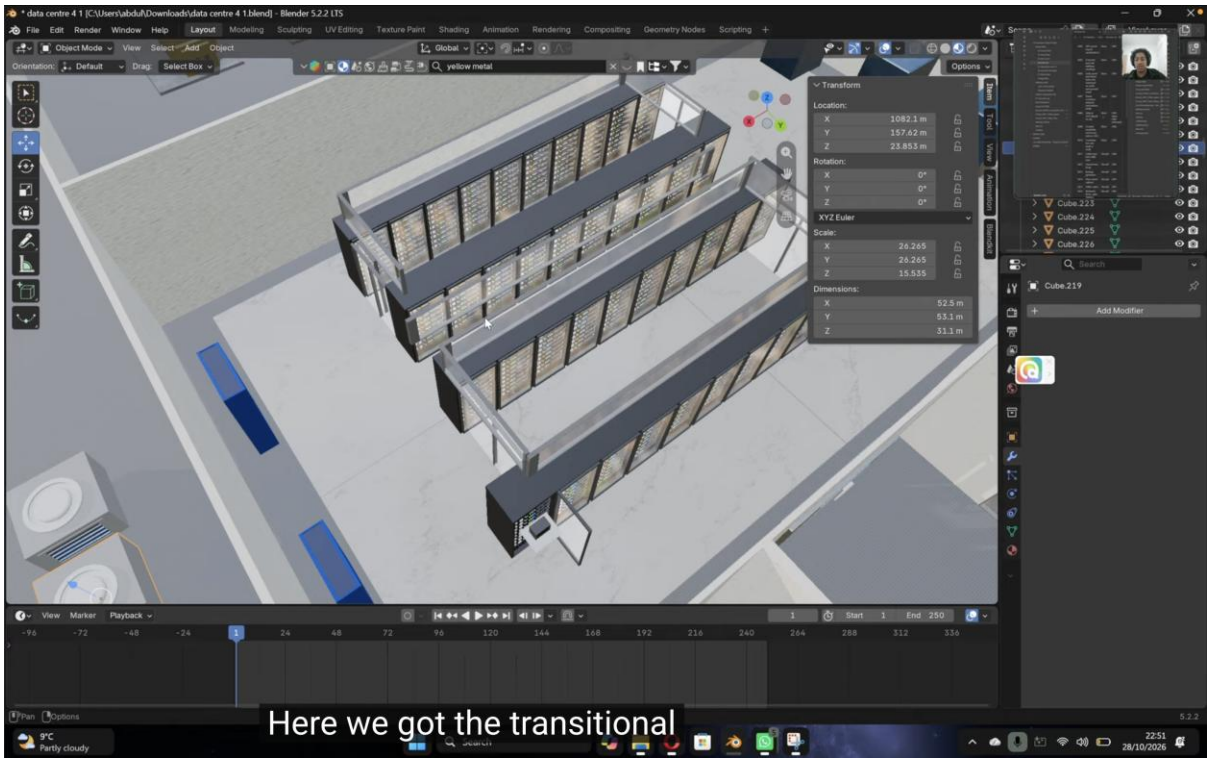
The things I thought they needed to fix were:

- The project was unfinished and they did not make it clear how the user will interact with the project
- Transferring the project from Blender to Unity

For each point I tried to suggest how they could improve it instead of just saying what was wrong. I also took a few things from their project into ours, for example [one thing you took].

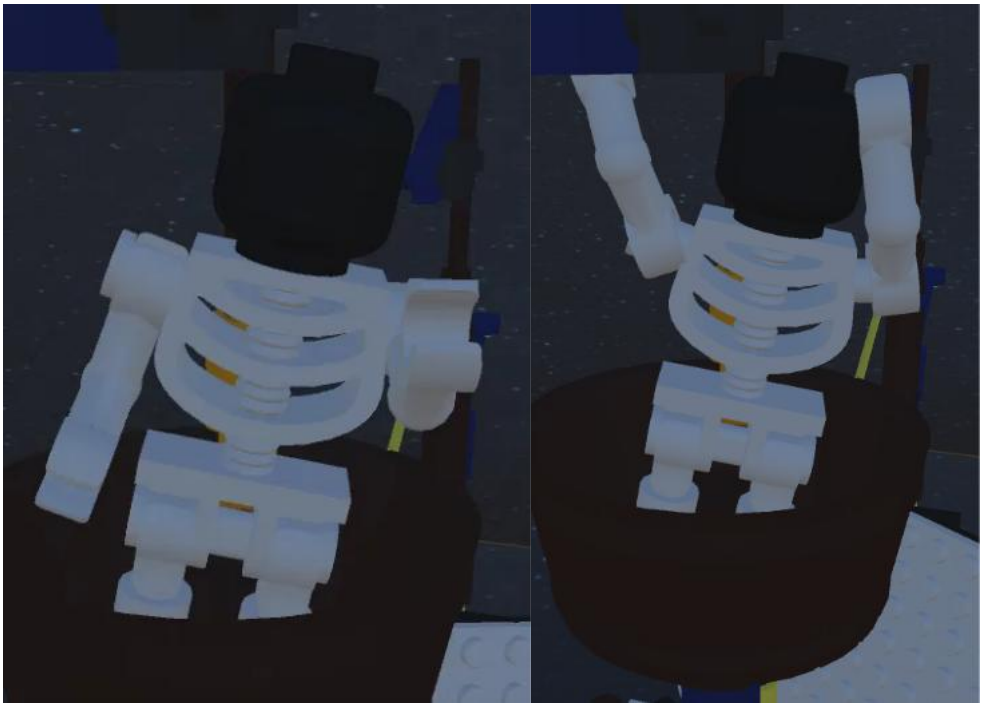
Recording the video was probably the hardest part of the whole coursework, funnily enough, because of all the technical problems I had. At first my MacBook would not record the video at all. When it did, it would not record any sound, even though all the settings were turned on. I had to record the video five times before it worked. Reading from the transcript helped a lot, because I did not stutter or pause for too long while thinking about what to say. After that, the video saved as a .mov file, which couldn't be uploaded , so I had to convert it to .mp4 before I could submit it. Exporting from QuickTime took extra time I had not planned for, and it taught me to test my recording setup early instead of leaving it until the end.





Lego Minifig Animation

The first task I had to complete was creating the Lego Figure in mechabricks, to then be added to the overall project model. The Lego figure I had created is a Pirate Skeleton, which is on the mast of the ship doing a waving animation with both arms, as you can see in the screenshots below.



As you can see the skeleton starts in an initial position with one arm coming up, then both are up, then right arm goes outward to start the wave and then goes in as left goes out and then they swap again and return to the start of the animation loop.

Group work

We used a shared Google account to work together on the project, and we made a GitHub early on to stay organised. We used WhatsApp to talk to each other when we were not in tutorials or at university. Caleb came up with the Treasure Planet idea, and we went on from there.

The idea and the communication worked well, because everyone knew the theme from the start and WhatsApp made it quick to ask questions. What did not work as well was putting everyone's work together. Merging was new to me so I had to learn it on the spot, and everyone was doing their own thing, which made it harder to combine the project.

To be honest, I did not do much of the technical work this time, like coding / building the main scene. This was because I focused on the animations and the peer review video, and I was busy with work and other modules

What I learned

There are a couple of things I will take away from this project. I learned how to make simple animations in Unity and how to use the brick controller, which I think is a good

base to build on in CW2. I also learned how much lighting changes a scene. You can see this in the screenshots, where the lighting makes the pirate ship look dark and gloomy.

The main issue for me was getting the items into position in Unity. I had to work out the spacing Unity uses, and the different movements do not always start at 0, so I had to keep changing the animations through trial and error until they looked the way I imagined. Watching Group 3's project showed me how much good research helps, because it made their idea feel more complete.

Giving feedback taught me to be clear and specific. Writing a transcript first helped me say exactly what I meant instead of just saying something looked good, and I tried to give them a way to improve with each comment. Reviewing their project also made me look at our own project more critically.

In CW2 I will do a few things differently. I will plan with my group who is doing what and by when, so we are not all doing our own thing and the project fits together better. I will practise merging on GitHub early so it is not new to me when it matters. I will test my animations in the main scene earlier so positioning problems show up sooner. I will also take on more of the technical work so I keep improving in Unity. Finally, I will test my recording setup a few days before the deadline, so technical problems do not take up as much time.